engendering a sense of common solidarity among their participants, and we were told this is an important objective.'[71]

While it is important to understand that these education-focused institutions fulfil a major welfare need and bridge wide gaps in the state's education system, they also help in moulding new generations into Hindutva thinking. In that sense, the ABVKA's cultural influence had a fundamental role in helping the BJP make political inroads into tribal areas.

Figure 14.6: Saraswati Shishu Mandir and Balasaheb Deoras Student Hostel, Deendayal Dham, Mathura



An image of Lord Krishna atop Kalia, the snake (representing a popular Krishna legend) in the courtyard of the Saraswati Shishu Mandir high school in Mathura.